StaffWare — Simple Guide to Screens and Workflows

This guide explains where to click, how the forms usually work, and how the main parts of StaffWare connect. It is written for people using the software, not just developers.

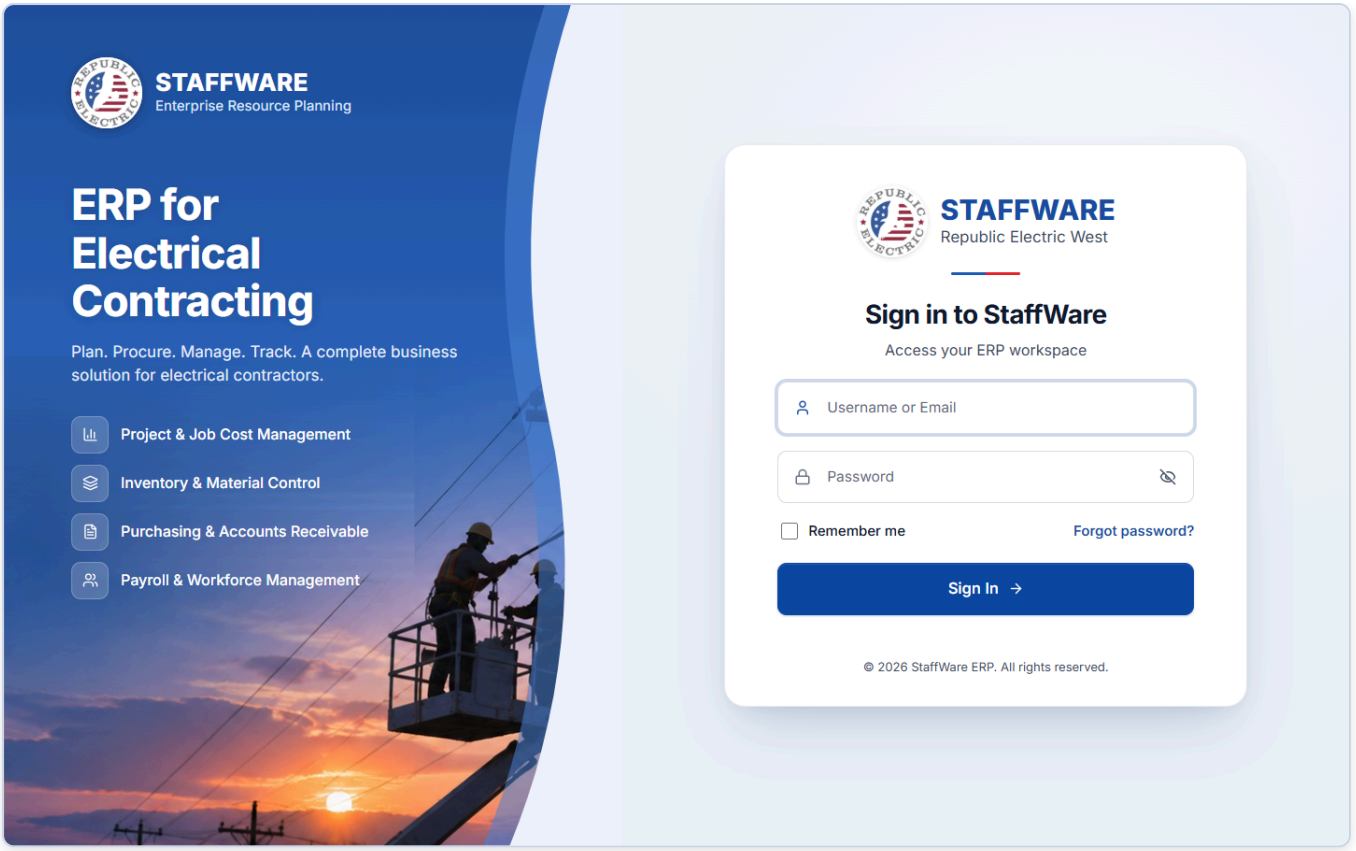
> **Safety:** Use training or test data when learning. Payroll, invoices, inventory posting, and Database Maintenance can change real business records.

> **About the screenshots:** they were captured from the running web app using fictional sample data (builder "Sample Homes Inc.", job "Oak Ridge Estates", and so on). Your screens will show your own company's records. Job Setup is used as the worked example because every module follows the same pattern.

Quick tour: your first five minutes

Step	What you do	What you see
1	Open the site and sign in.	Login page below.
2	Land on the Dashboard.	Reminders, totals, and module shortcuts.
3	Pick a module on the left (or press **Ctrl K**).	The module's overview with tabs.
4	Open a list, search, and click a row.	The record's form.
5	Edit, then **Save**.	A success or error message.

Step 1 — Sign in

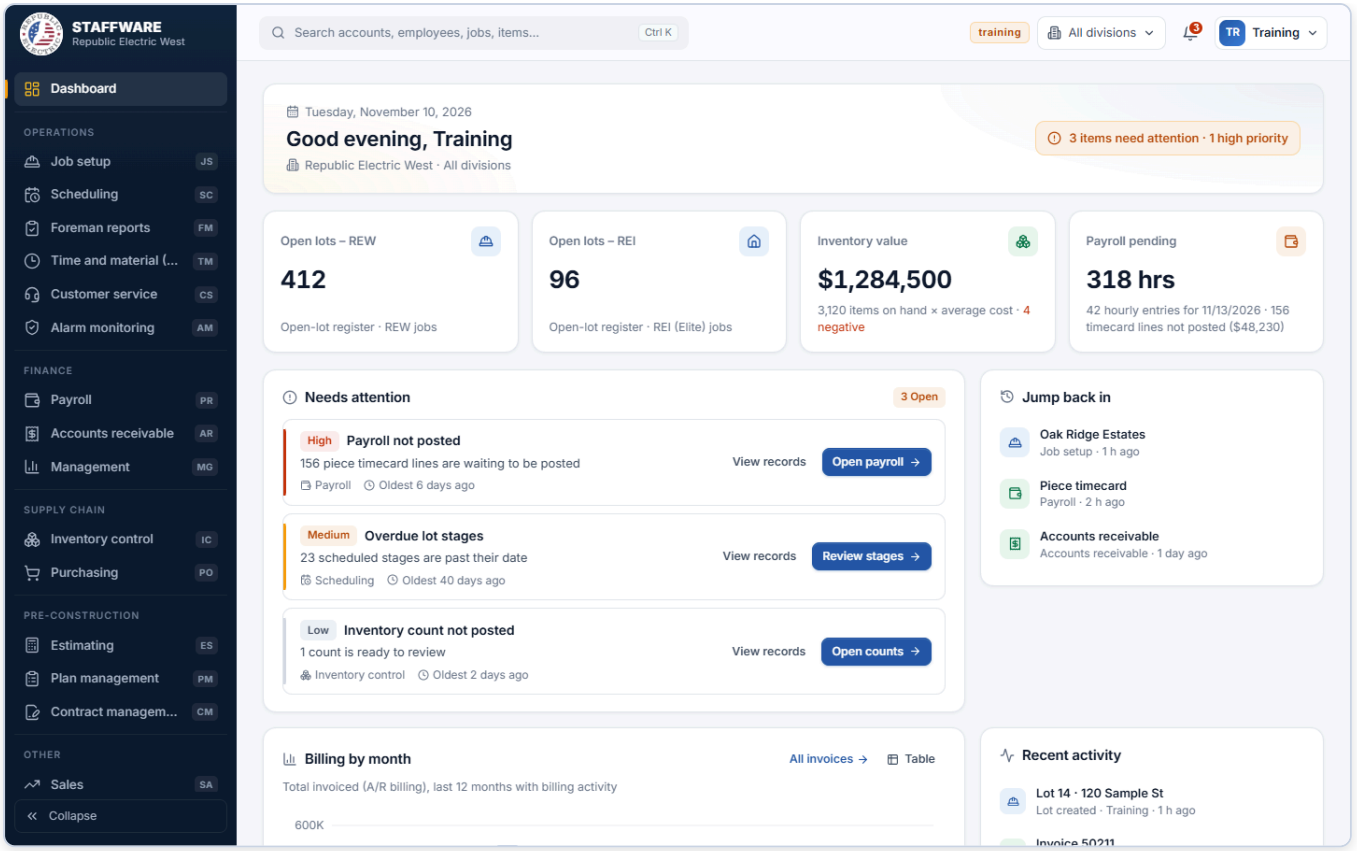


Login screen

1. Type your **Username or Email** and **Password**. The eye icon shows or hides the password.
2. Tick **Remember me** to have the username filled in next time.
3. Click **Sign In** (or press Enter).

Behind the scenes: the page sends your login to the server, which replies with your name and the list of modules you are allowed to use. The login itself is kept in a protected browser cookie that page scripts cannot read. The menu is drawn from your module list, and the server checks permission again on every request.

Step 2 — The Dashboard

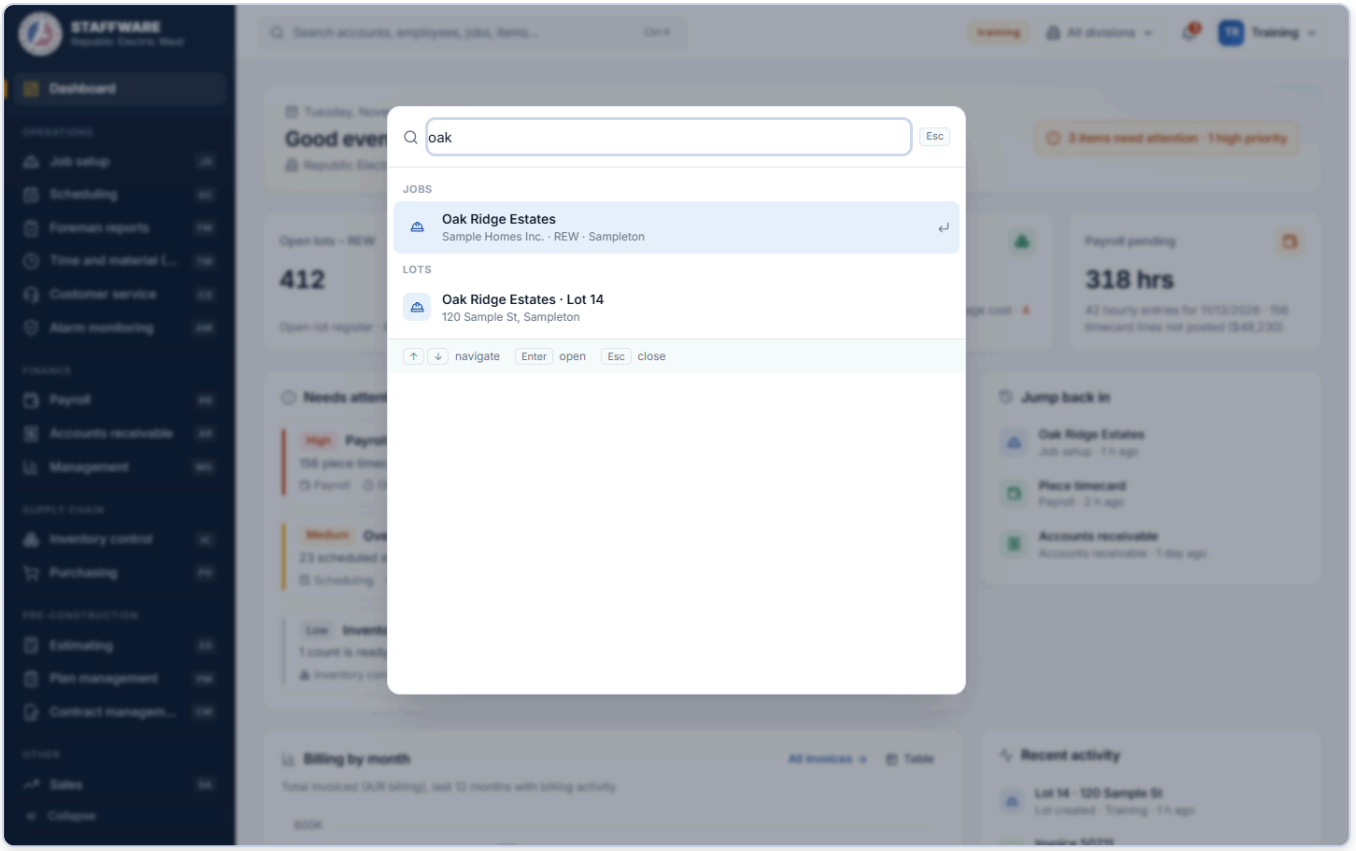


Dashboard

Area	What it tells you	Click to...
Left menu	Every module you may use, grouped (Operations, Finance, Supply chain...). The two-letter code is the module's permission code.	Open that module.
Top bar	Search, an environment tag (here "training"), the **division** filter, the alerts bell, and your account menu.	Search, switch division, see alerts.
Welcome banner	Date, your name, selected division, and a count of items needing attention.	Jump to the attention list.
KPI cards	Open lots (REW and REI), inventory value, payroll pending. Only cards for modules you can use appear.	Open the matching detail report.
Needs attention	Prioritized to-dos (High / Medium / Low) such as unposted payroll or overdue stages.	**Open...** goes to the screen that fixes it; **View records** lists the underlying rows.
Jump back in	The last screens you opened on this computer.	Return to that screen.
Charts and Recent activity	Billing by month, piece-rate payroll, and a feed of latest changes.	Click a bar to see that month or pay date.

Behind the scenes: the Dashboard makes four requests (summary, attention, charts, activity). Changing the **division** in the top bar re-runs the summary only. "Jump back in" is stored in your browser, so it is per computer, not per user.

Step 3 — Search from anywhere (Ctrl K)



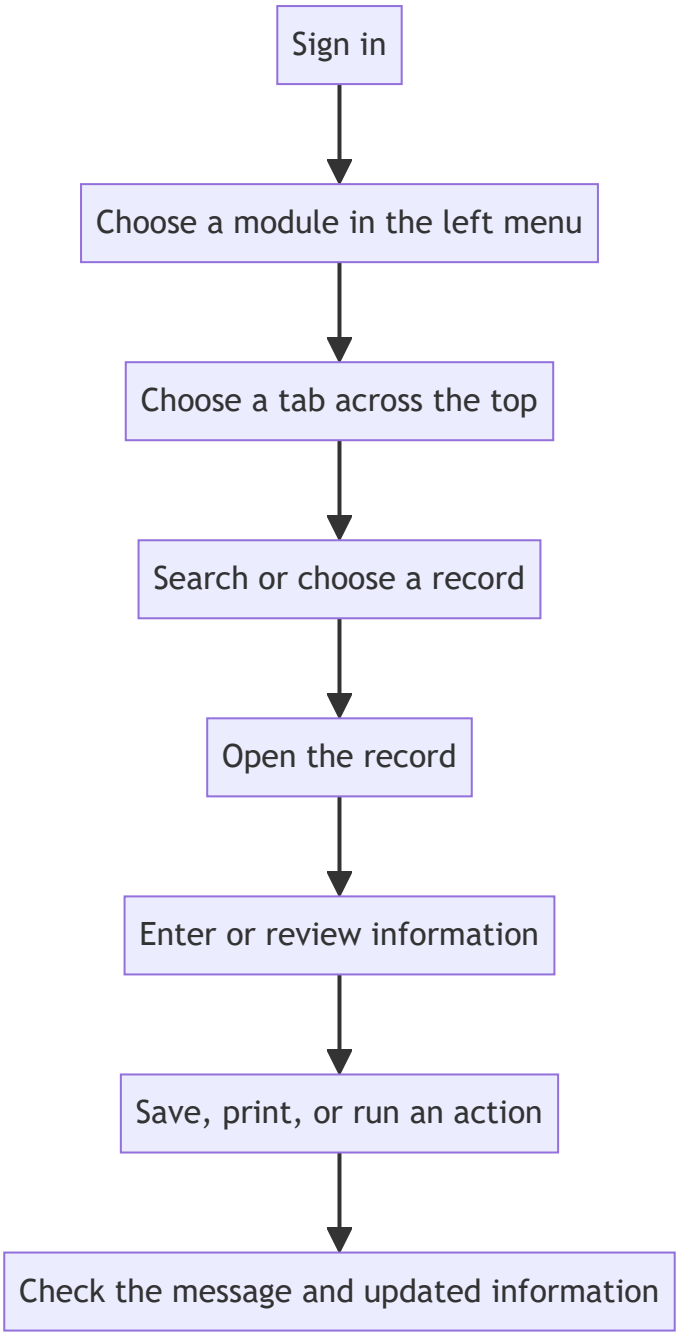
Global search

Press **Ctrl K** (or click the search box), then type at least two letters. Modules matching your text appear first, followed by matching jobs, lots, accounts, employees, items, and so on. Use ↑ / ↓ to move, **Enter** to open, **Esc** to close.

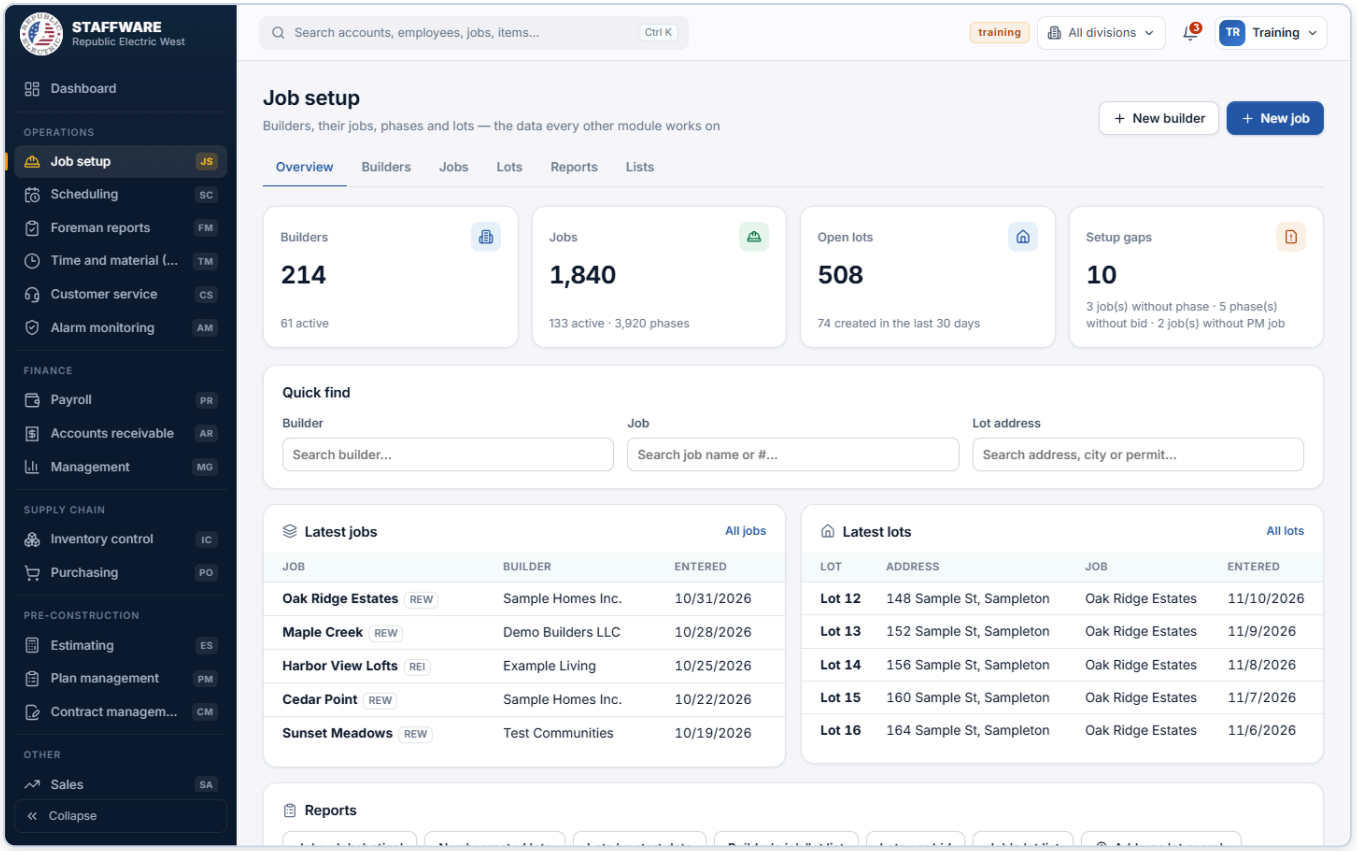
Behind the scenes: after a short pause in typing, the page asks the server to search. Modules are filtered locally from your permission list.

1. Find your way around

After signing in, use the app like this:



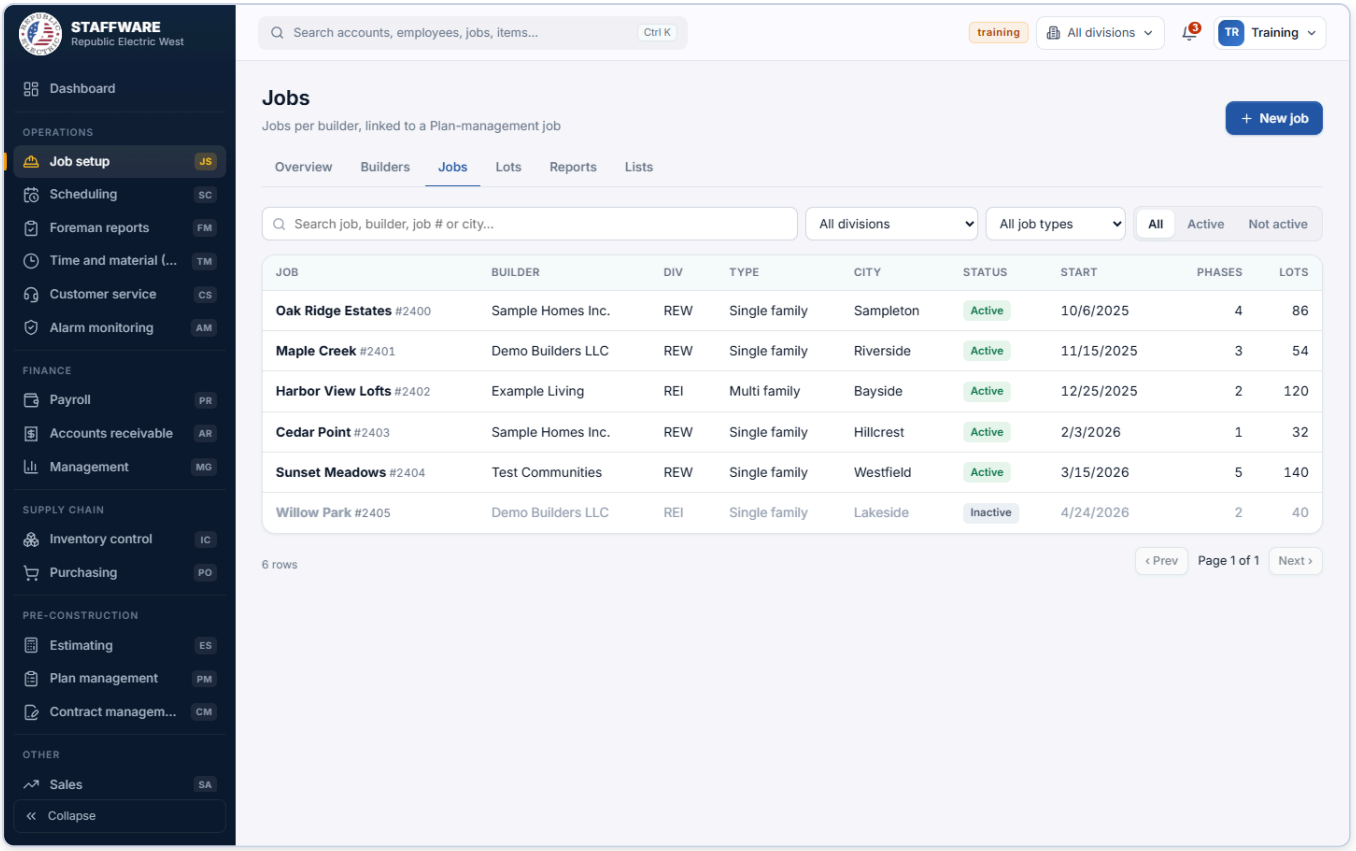
A module's overview page (example: Job Setup). The tabs across the top (Overview, Builders, Jobs, Lots, Reports, Lists) are the module's screens.



Module overview

- **Overview cards** are counts that you can click to open the filtered list.
- **Quick find** looks up a builder, job, or lot address and opens it directly.
- **Latest jobs / Latest lots** open a record when you click a row.
- **Reports** buttons open a prepared report with its filters.

A list screen (example: Jobs):



List screen

1. Type in the search box. The list updates after a short pause.
2. Narrow it with the **division**, **job type**, and **All / Active / Not active** controls. Filters are kept in the page address, so you can bookmark or share the filtered view.
3. Click a row to open its record. Greyed rows are inactive.
4. Use **Prev / Next** at the bottom (25 rows per page here).

- **Left menu:** choose an area of work, such as Job Setup, Payroll, or Purchasing.
- **Tabs across the page:** move between that area's overview, records, and reports.
- **Search and filters:** narrow a list. A row is often clickable to open its details.
- **Back / breadcrumb links:** return to the list or parent record.
- **Dashboard:** shows reminders and shortcuts. Selecting a reminder opens related records.
- **No access message:** your login may not have permission for that module. Ask an administrator.

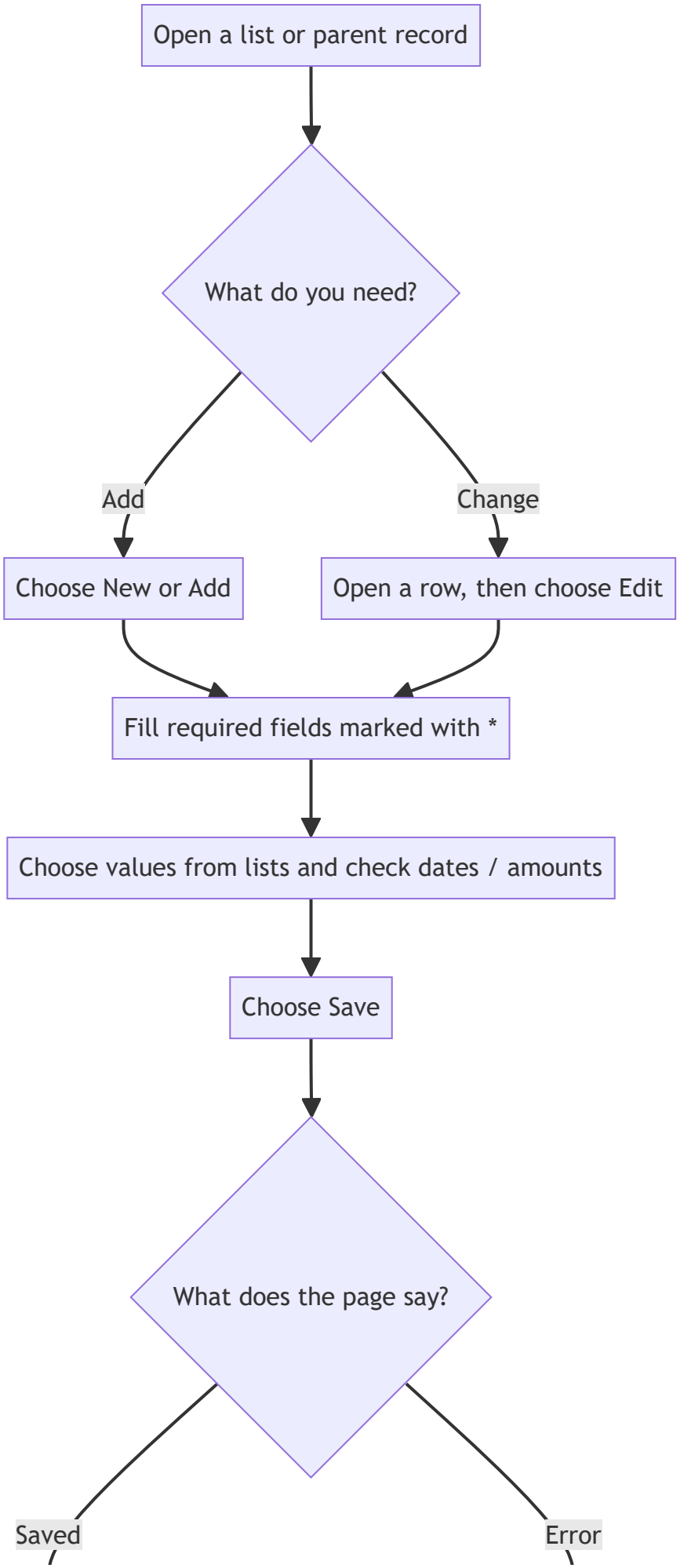
Common buttons

Button or control	What it usually does
New / Add / +	Opens a blank form to create a record.
Pencil / Edit	Opens an existing record for changes.
Save / Create	Sends the form to be saved. Look for a success message or updated record.
Delete / trash	Removes a record. Read the confirmation carefully; some deletes cannot be undone.
Search	Finds matching records. Some lists search while you type; others need Enter or a short pause.

Button or control	What it usually does
Filters / dates	Limit which records or report rows are shown.
Print / CSV	Prints the displayed information or downloads a spreadsheet.
Post / Process / Transfer / Update	Performs a business action that may write many records. Review its confirmation and result count.

2. How to use a form

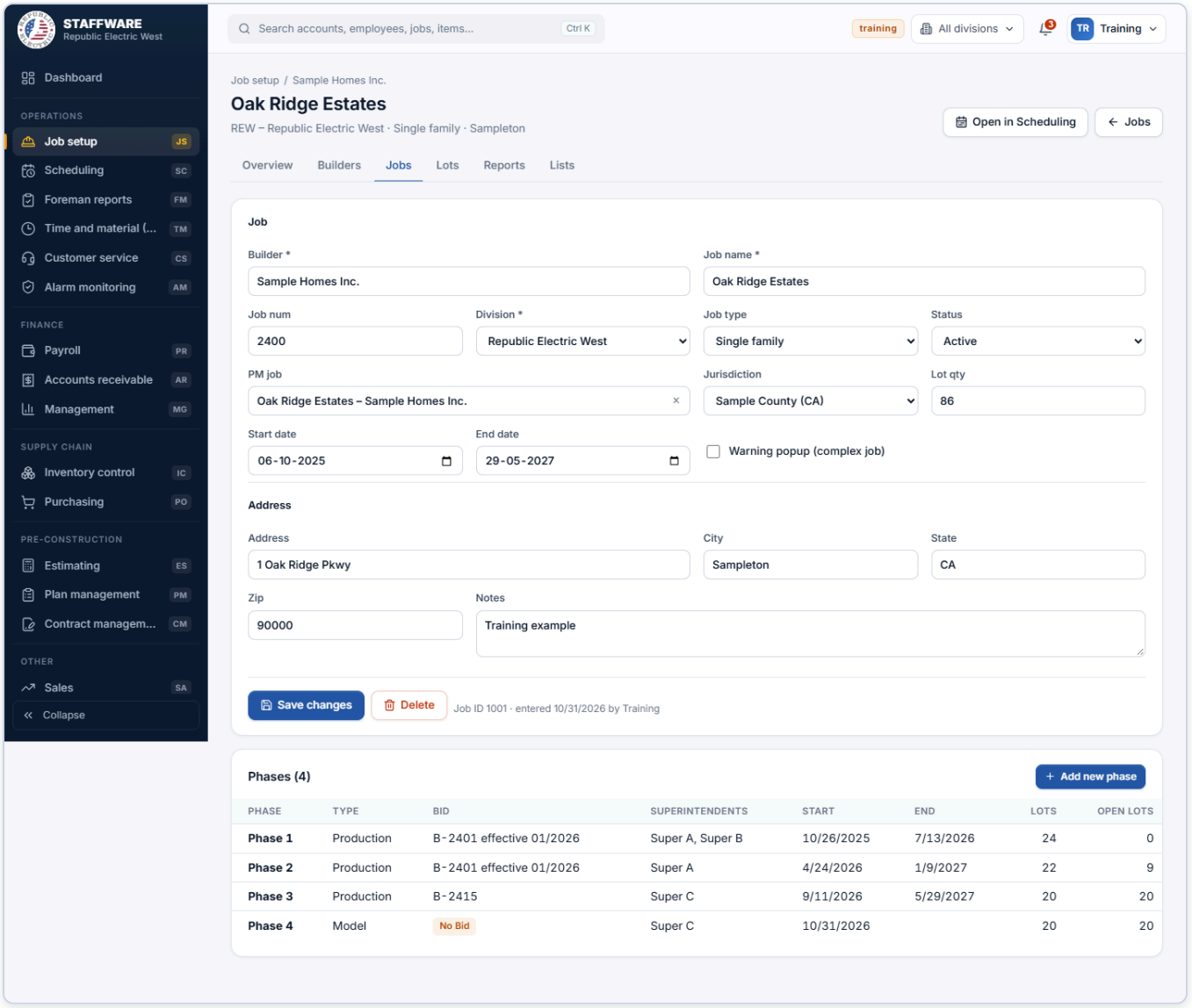
Most entry screens follow the same pattern:


Open a list or parent record
What do you need?
Add
Change
Choose New or Add
Open a row, then choose Edit
Fill required fields marked with *
Choose values from lists and check dates / amounts
Choose Save
What does the page say?
Saved
Error

Review the saved record

Read the message, correct the form, and try again

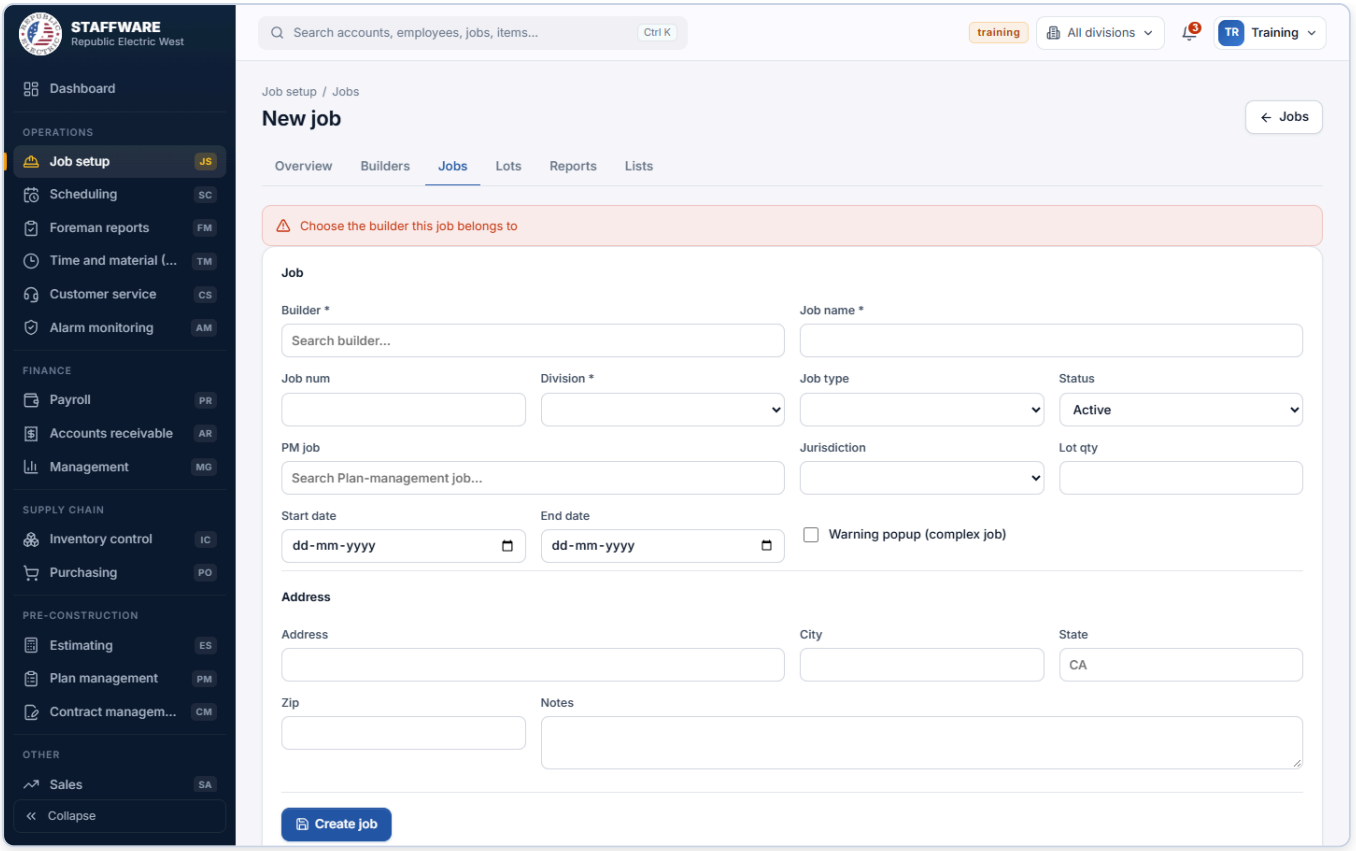
Editing an existing record



Record form

1. The **breadcrumb** (Job setup / Sample Homes Inc.) shows the parent record; click it to go up a level.
2. Fields marked `*` are required. The **Builder** is locked once the job exists.
3. Search boxes (such as **PM job**) are type-ahead pickers: type, then click a match. The **×** clears it.
4. **Save changes** sends only what you changed. If nothing changed, you see "Nothing changed".
5. **Child tables** (here **Phases**) sit under the form. Click a row to open it, or **Add new phase**.
6. The footer shows the record ID and who entered it and when.

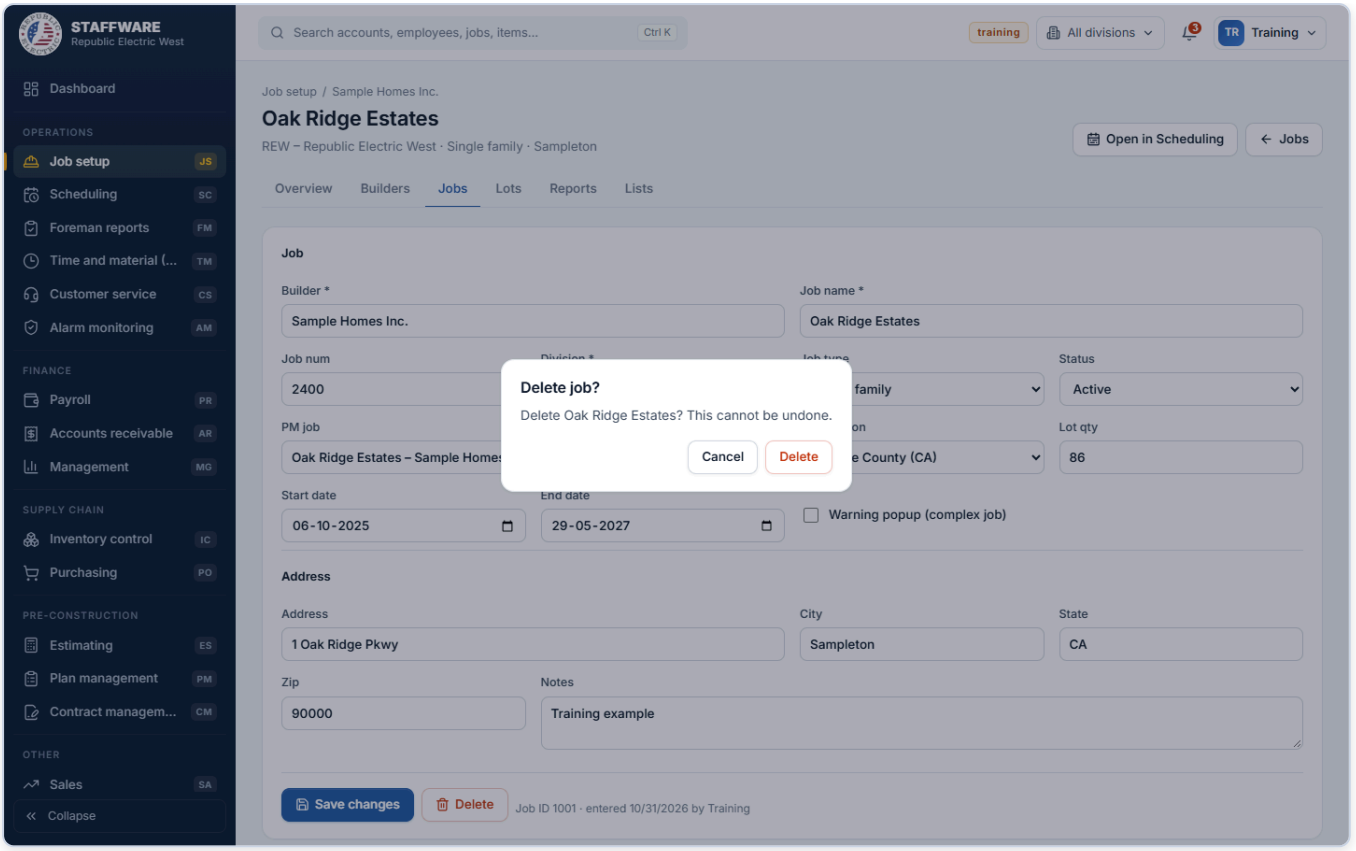
Creating a new record



New record form with an error

Choose **New job**. If you click **Create job** without a required value, a red message explains what is missing (here, the builder) and nothing is saved. Fix it and save again. After a successful create, the app opens the new record.

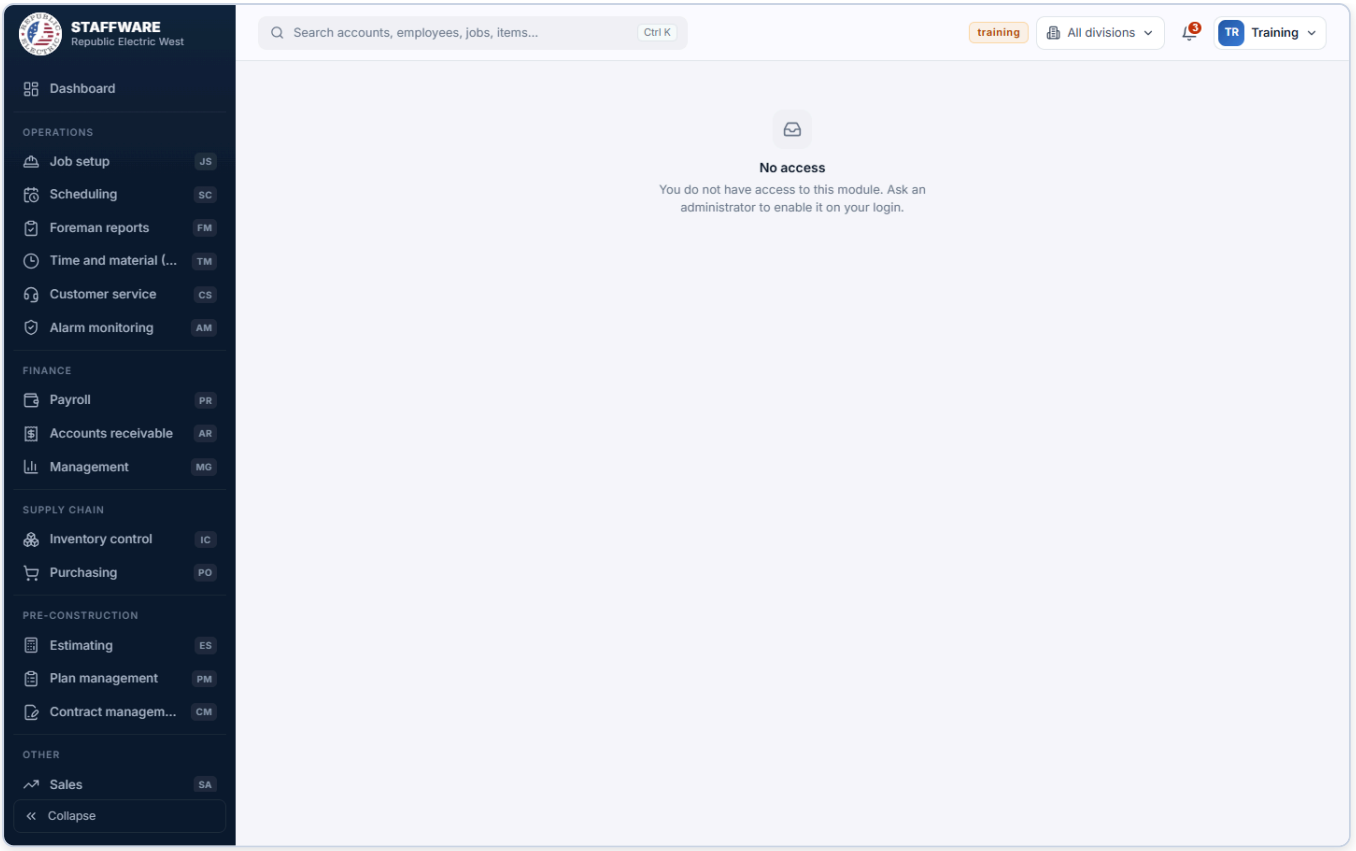
Deleting and risky links



Delete confirmation

Delete always asks first. Some saves also ask: for example, changing the link between a Scheduling job and a Plan Management job, or selecting an inactive PM job, shows a "Are you sure?" box. Read it before confirming. If other records depend on the one you are deleting, the server refuses and shows a message.

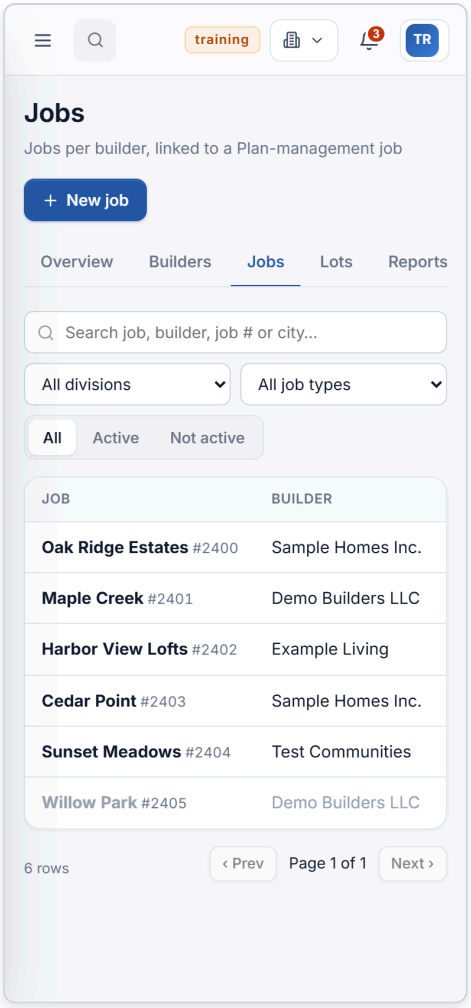
If you do not have access



No access message

Opening a module you are not permitted to use shows this page. Ask an administrator to enable the module on your login.

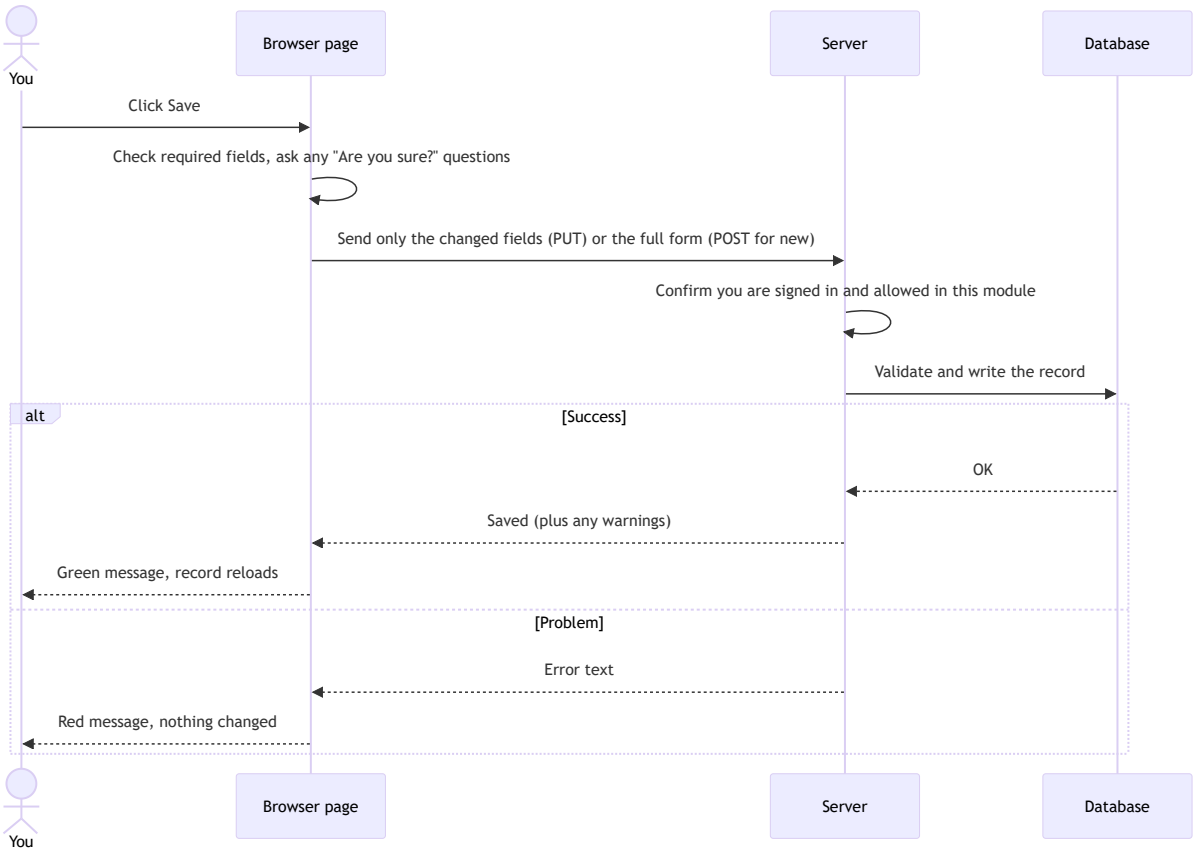
On a phone or narrow window



Mobile list view

On small screens the left menu collapses behind a menu button at the top.

Behind the scenes — what a Save really does:



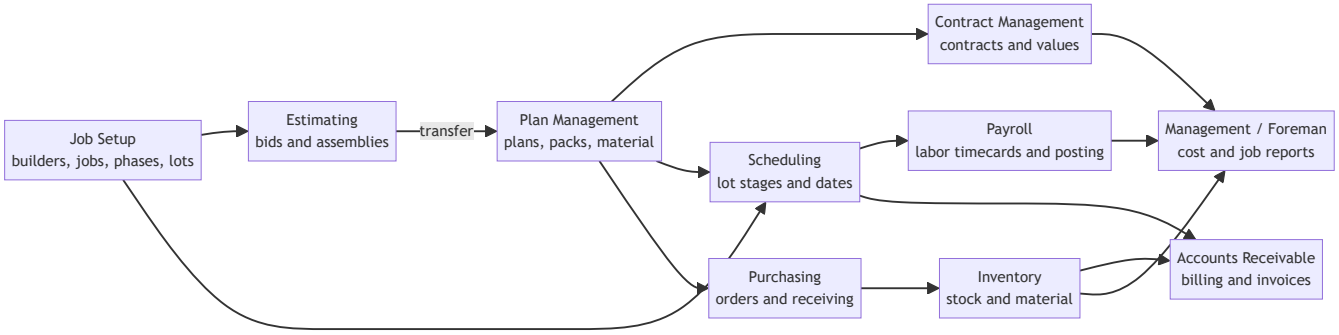
Before you save:

1. Check that you opened the right customer, job, lot, employee, or invoice.
2. Fill in fields marked with `*`; choose related records from the pick lists.
3. Check dates, quantities, percentages, and dollar amounts.
4. Select **Save** once. Wait for the confirmation or error message.
5. Re-open or refresh the record to make sure the values were saved.
6. For a delete, post, invoice, or bulk update, read the confirmation first. If unsure, cancel and ask your supervisor.

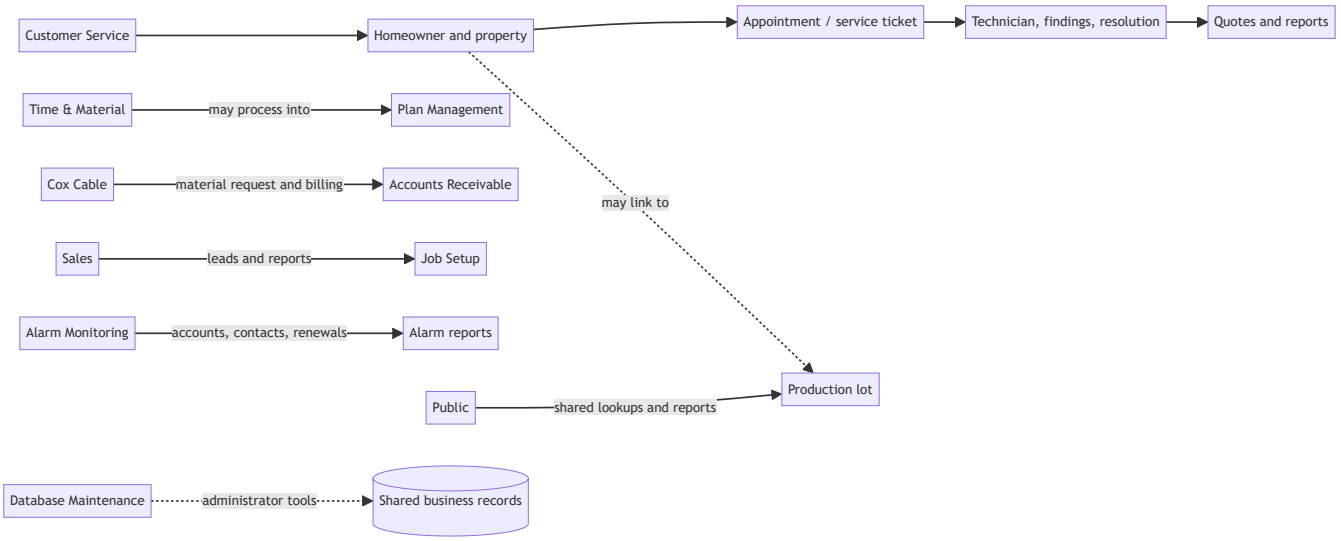
Some screens have extra tables under the main form, such as contacts, zones, phone numbers, or material lines. Use the controls beside those rows to add or edit the child records, then check that the list refreshes.

3. How the main work connects

This map shows the broad production flow. Not every company task uses every box, and the order may differ by job.



Other work connects too:



4. What each module is for

Use the left menu to open a module. The tabs inside it lead to the screens listed below.

Menu name	Use it for	Common path through the screens
Job Setup (JS)	Builders, jobs, phases, and production lots.	Builder → Job → Phase → Lot
Estimating (ES)	Preparing bids, plans, assemblies, packs, and material; transferring a bid to Plan Management.	Customer → Job → Bid → Plan → Assemblies / Packs → Material → Transfer
Plan Management (PM)	Maintaining customer jobs, bids, plans, packs, and pack material.	Customer → Job → Bid → Plan → Pack → Material
Contract Management (CM)	Contracts and addenda, diary reminders, bid links, and contract values.	Job → Contract → Diary / Bid links / Values
Scheduling (SC)	Scheduling production work by job, phase, lot, pack, and stage.	Job → Phase → Lot → Schedule stages / dates
Payroll (PR)	Piece and hourly timecards, employees, pay periods, and payroll reports.	Payroll date → Enter time → Review timecards → Append hourly if needed → Post
Purchasing (PO)	Purchase orders, order lines, receiving, and purchasing reports.	Vendor → Purchase order → Items → Receipt / billing
Inventory Control (IC)	Items, vendors, stock, counts, material, and inventory posting.	Item / Vendor → Transactions or Count → Review → Post
Accounts Receivable (AR)	Billing lots, reviewing pre-bills, invoices, credits, and AR reports.	Billing work → Lot / stage → Pre-bill → Invoice
Management (MG)	Job cost, profit, labor, and lot reports.	Choose report → Set filters → Review totals / details

Menu name	Use it for	Common path through the screens
Foreman Reports (FM)	Start packets, sequence sheets, work-in-progress, labor, and material reports.	Choose report → Select job / lot / date → Review or print
Customer Service (CS)	Homeowners, properties, appointments, service tickets, technicians, and quotes.	Homeowner ↔ Property → Appointment / Ticket → Technician / Resolution
Time & Material (TM)	Creating and tracking T&M orders or quotes, including processing and payment.	New T&M → Add details → Process / Print → Track payment
Cox Cable (CX)	Cox setup, material requests, billing information, and Cox invoices.	Setup → Check date / eligibility → Request material or preview billing → Process
Sales (SA)	Sales leads and sales reports.	Lead → Contact details / status → Reports
Alarm Monitoring (AM)	Alarm accounts, contacts, zones, renewals, audit, and printouts.	Account list → Account → Contacts / Zones → Renewals or Reports
Public (PU)	Shared address/lot searches and job, lot, and plan lookups.	Search address or choose report → Open result
Database Maintenance (DM)	Login permissions, lookup lists, repair tools, and bulk actions.	Administrator only: choose tool → review affected records → confirm action

Example: follow a job from setup to billing

